

Ans. (c)

Pandya king of South India sent an ambassador to the kingdom of Rome in 26 B.C. Pandya dynasty had the most prolonged duration of reign in South Indian region. Their capital was Madurai.

88. Who established trade relations with Roman empire?

- (a) Kushanas
- (b) Cheras
- (c) Western Shakas
- (d) Vakatakas
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2022

Ans. (b)

India's trade with the Roman empire started with the Chera Kingdom during the Sangam period. Many Roman objects were found from Arikamedu (Puducherry).

89. Meenakshi Mandir is located at:

- (a) Madurai
- (b) Pudukottai
- (c) Sri Rangam
- (d) Thanjavur

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

Meenakshi temple is situated at Madurai. Madurai was the capital of Pandyas. During the Sangama era, 1st and 3rd Sangam were organised here, which were presided over by Acharya Agastya and Nakkirar respectively.

90. Meenakshi Temple is situated here –

- (a) Chennai
- (b) Kolkata
- (c) Madurai
- (d) Mahabalipuram

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

91. Match the following :

List – I

A. Meenakshi Mandir

B. Venkateswara Mandir

C. Mahakal Mandir

D. Bellore Matha

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) | 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) | 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 |
| (d) | 3 | 4 | 2 | 1 |

List – II

1. Tirumala (Andhra Pradesh)

2. Madurai (Balaji Vishwanath)

3. Howrah (West Bengal)

4. Ujjain

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Meenakshi temple was originally built by Kulasekara Pandya. It is located in Madurai, and the lotus-shaped city surrounds it completely. Mahakal temple is located in Ujjain and Venkateswara Mandir is located in Tirumala (Andhra Pradesh). Bellore Matha is the headquarters of the Ramakrishna Mission, founded by Swami Vivekananda, a chief disciple of Ramakrishna Paramhansa.

92. The mighty gateways found at the temples of South India are called

- (a) Shikhars
- (b) Gopurams
- (c) Devalayas
- (d) Mandapams
- (e) None of the above/more than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre)-2017

Ans. (b)

The mighty gateways found at the temples of South India are called Gopurams. The Dravidian style flourished during the Pandyas and Cholas. In the Pandya period, the temples were small, but many ramparts were built around their courtyard. Their gateways, which were called Gopurams; were grand, spacious and richly ornamented with craftsmanship. The speciality of Chola period architecture is not the temple, but the Gopuram.

Ancient Literature and Litterateur

*The Greek author Herodotus is often known as the 'Father of History'. His famous book 'Historica' describes the Indo-Persian relations during the 5th century BCE. *Mudrarakshasa written by Vishakhadatta is a drama in Sanskrit. Although written during the Gupta period, it describes how Chandragupta, with the assistance of Kautilya, overthrew the Nandas. It also gives a picture of the socio-economic condition under the Mauryas. *Sanskrit literature reached its peak during the Gupta period. This era is known for writing of prose and as well as poetry. **Amarakosh** by Amar Singh, **Kamasutra** by Vatsyayana, Meghdoot by Kalidasa and **Mudrarakshasa** by Vishakhadatta are among the classic literature composed during this period.

*The famous authors and their books :

Surdas - Sursagar, Sur Saravali, Sahitya Lahiri

Dandin (Dandi) - Daskumarcharitam

Tulsidas - Ramcharitmanas, Vinaya Patrika, Kavitavali

Kalidasa - Abhigyanashakuntalam, Kumarsambhavam, Malavikagnimitram, Meghdootam.

***Naishadhiyacharita** is a story of Nala and Damayanti in the Mahabharata written by Sriharsha; **Kiratarjuniyam** is an epic poem describing combat between Arjuna and Lord Shiva.

*Magha wrote **Sisupalavadha**. ***Dashkumarcharitam** was written by Dandi and describes the adventures of 10 princes.

*The **Panchasiddhantika** of Varahamihira is based on Greek astronomy. The **Milindapanha** is a Buddhist text in Pali language which is a dialogue between the Indian monk **Nagasena** and the Indo-Greek king **Milinda** (Menander).

***Jai Singh** (1128-1149) was the contemporary ruler of **Kashmir**. Kalhana was the author of **Rajatarangini**. He completed this pioneer creation during the reign of Jai Singh.

***Rajatarangini**, a metrical historical chronicle of the north-western Indian subcontinent, particularly the kings of Kashmir was written in Sanskrit.

***Ashvaghosha**, a noted poet, is considered to be instrumental in the propagation of Buddhism. He was also the writer of a famous court poem of his time called the **Saundarananda** Kavya. This poem was discovered and edited by Pandit Haraprasada Shastri. ***Buddhacharita** is a poetic narrative of the life of Buddha by the Sanskrit poet Asvaghosha.

***Harshavardhana** was also a great lover of education and learning. He is supposed to be the author of '**Ratnavali**,' '**Priyadarshika**' and '**Nagananda**.' Historians say "Harsha was a patron of letters. He appears to have wielded the pen with no less dexterity and effect than the sword". There are three plays authored by him viz., the '**Ratnavali**,' '**Priyadarsika**' and the '**Nagananda**'. It is said that it was composed by a King named Harshadeva. This royal author has been identified with Harsha of Kannauj since it is contended that no other sovereign of this name can meet the requirements of the case. ***Kalidasa** was a Sanskrit poet and dramatist and probably the greatest Indian writer of any epoch. The seven works identified as genuine are (1) **Abhijnanashakuntalam**, (2) **Vikramorvashiyam**, (3) **Malavikagnimitram**, (4) **Raghuvamsham**, (5) **Kumarasambhavam**, (6) **Meghadutam**, (7) **Ritusamharam**. *The first play composed by the great poet Kalidasa is **Malavikagnimitram**. Often it is called **Kalidasa Malavikagnimitram**, as an honour to Kalidasa. This play consists of 5 acts about the love story of King **Agnimitra** of Vidisha from the Shunga dynasty (presumed to have ruled Magadha) and **Malavika**.

***'Svapnavasavdattam'** is a Sanskrit play written by the great poet Bhasa. ***Geet Govind** is an epic poem, written in Sanskrit by Jayadev in the twelfth century. Jayadev was the royal poet in the court of King **Lakshman Sen** of Bengal.

Panchatantra is a collection of Indian animal fables which has had extensive circulation both in the country of its origin

and throughout the world. It has been translated into 15 Indian and 40 foreign languages. It was compiled in Sanskrit (Hindu) and Pali (Buddhist). The compilation is attributed to **Pandit Vishnu Sharma**. *In Mughal era, it was translated by **Abul Fazl** under the name of **Ayar-e-danish**.

***Bhaskaracharya** is also known as **Bhaskara - II** known for significant contributions to mathematical and astronomical knowledge in the 12th century. There are six well-known works of Bhaskaracharya. His book **Siddhantasiromani** has four parts - **Lilavati**, **Bijaganita**, **Ganitadhyay** and **Goladhyay**.

***Aryabhatta** was a renowned mathematician and astronomer of ancient India. One of his major works was **Aryabhatiya**. The book deals with many topics like astronomy, spherical trigonometry, arithmetic, algebra and plane trigonometry. *In the field of astronomy, Aryabhatta was the pioneer to infer that the earth is spherical and rotates on its axis around the sun. He is also considered to be the father of Trigonometry.

***Mattavilasa Prahasana** was written by the versatile Pallava ruler and scholar Mahendravarman I.

***Manusmriti**, also known as **Manav Dharam Shashtra**, is mainly related to the social system. It is the earliest metrical work on Brahminical Dharma in Hinduism. Manu is considered to be the originator of law in India.

***'Zero'** was discovered by an anonymous Indian. Arabians learned it from India and carried it over to Europe. It was found that the Arabs first used zero in 873 A.D. "**The Natural History**" is the creation of '**Pliny the Elder**,' a Roman author.

Some Important books and their authors –

Books	Authors
Sursagar, Sur Saravali , - Sahitya-Lahiri	Surdasa
Daskumarcharitam -	Dandin (Dandi)
Ramcharitmanas, Vinaya -	Tulsidasa
Patrika, Kavitavali	
Abhigyanshakuntalam, -	Kalidasa
Kumarsambhavam, Malavikagnimitram, Meghadutam	
Ashtadhyayi -	Panini
Kamasutra -	Vatsyayana
Arthashastra -	Chanakya
Rajatarangini -	Kalhana
Kiratarjuniyam -	Bharavi
Nagananda -	Harsha
Karpuramanjari -	Rajasekhara
Brihatsamhita -	Varahamihira
Devi-Chandraguptam -	Vishakhadatta
Mrichchhakatikam -	Sudraka
VikramankadevCharita -	Bilhana
Katantra -	Saravarma
Mitakhara -	Vigyaneshwara

1. The title 'Father of History' rightly belongs to :

- (a) Herodotus (b) Euripides
(c) Thucydides (d) Socrates

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

The Greek author Herodotus is often known as the 'Father of History'. His famous book, 'Historica' describes the Indo-Persian relations during the 5th century B.C.

2. Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- | List-I | List-II |
|---------------|--------------|
| A Ashtadhyayi | 1. Yaska |
| B Mahabhashya | 2. Katyayan |
| C Nirukta | 3. Patanjali |
| D Varttika | 4. Panini |

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 |
| (b) | 2 | 3 | 1 | 4 |
| (c) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (d) | 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 |

[U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains)-2017]

Ans. (a)

The correctly matched list is as follows -

- | List-I | List-II |
|-------------|-------------|
| Ashtadhyayi | – Panini |
| Mahabhashya | – Patanjali |
| Nirukta | – Yaska |
| Varttika | – Katyayan |

3. Who of the following was the writer of Mudrarakshasa ?

- (a) Aswaghosha (b) Vishakhadatta
(c) Kalidasa (d) Bhasa

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

Mudrarakshasa written by Vishakhadatta is a drama in Sanskrit. Although written during the Gupta period, it describes how Chandragupta Maurya with the assistance of Kautilya overthrew the Nandas. It also gives a picture of the socio-economic condition under the Mauryas.

4. Who was the author of Mudrarakshasa?

- (a) Hemchandra (b) Ballal
(c) Vishakhadatta (d) Padmagupta

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

5. Which of the following classical works of literature were written during the Gupta Era ?

1. Amarakosh
2. Kamasutra
3. Meghaduta
4. Mudrarakshasa

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (d)

Sanskrit literature reached its apogee in the Gupta period. This era is known for equal writing of prose and poetry. Amarakosh by Amar Singh, Kamasutra by Vatsyayana, Meghadutam by Kalidasa and Mudrarakshasa by Vishakhadatta are among the classic literature composed during this period.

6. Daskumarcharitam was composed by –

- (a) Surdas (b) Dandin
(c) Tulsidas (d) Kalidas

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (b)

The famous authors and their books :

Surdas - Sursagar, Sur Saravali, Sahitya-Lahiri
Dandin (Dandi)- Daskumarcharitam
Tulsidas - Ramcharit Manas, Vinaya Patrika, Kavitavali
Kalidasa - Abhigyanshakuntalam,
Kumarsambhavam, Malavikagnimitram,
Meghadutam.

7. Who wrote Daskumarcharitam?

- (a) Bharavi (b) Bilhana
(c) Dandin (d) Soma deva

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

8. 'Kumarasambhava,' an epic poem was composed by –

- (a) Banabhatta (b) Chanda Bardai
(c) Harishena (d) Kalidasa

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

9. Which of the following dramas was not written by Kalidasa?

- (a) Malavikagnimitram (b) Abhigyan Shakuntalam
(c) Kumarsambhavam (d) Janaki haranam

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

In the given options all the epics are written by Kalidasa except Janaki-haranam. Janaki-haranam was written by Kumaradasa.

10. Which one of the following books is not written by Kalidasa?

- (a) Meghadutam (b) Kumarsambhavam
(c) Uttararamacharitam (d) Ritusamharam

[M.P. P.C.S. (Pre)-2017]

Ans. (c)

Uttaramacharitam is a Sanskrit play in seven acts describing the life of Lord Rama. It was written by great poet Bhavabhuti.

11. 'Bible Book' of North Indian classical music is related to

- (a) Natyashastra (b) Sursagar
(c) Nad-Vinad (d) Sufinama

U.P.B.E.O. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

The Bible of North Indian classical music is Natyashastra. It is a Sanskrit treatise on the performing arts. It is attributed to Bharat Muni.

12. Match the following:-

- A. Panini (1) Kamasutra
B. Vatsyayana (2) Rajatarangini
C. Chanakya (3) Ashtadhyayi
D. Kalhana (4) Arthashastra

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 |
| (b) | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| (c) | 2 | 3 | 1 | 4 |
| (d) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

The correctly matched pairs are :

Panini	-	Ashtadhyayi
Vatsyayana	-	Kamasutra
Chanakya	-	Arthashastra
Kalhana	-	Rajatarangini

13. What is the name of Kalhana's book?

- (a) Arthashastra (b) Indica
(c) Purana (d) Rajatarangini

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

14. 'Rajatarangini' written by Kalhana is associated with which of the following ?

- (a) Chandragupta's reign
(b) Anthology of lyrics
(c) History of Kashmir
(d) Reign of Krishna Deva Raya

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

Kalhana, a Kashmiri, was the author of Rajatarangini (River of Kings) which gives an account of the history of Kashmir.

15. 'Ashtadhyayi' was written by –

- (a) Vedavyas (b) Panini
(c) Shukadeva (d) Valmiki

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

16. A historical work "Gaudavaho" like Kalhana's "Rajatarangini" was written by :

- (a) Sandhyakaranandin (b) Vakpati
(c) Banabhatta (d) Bilhana

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans. (b)

The Gaudavaho is a Prakrit epic poem composed by Vakpati, a poet living in the court of Yasovarman, king of Kanauj. The poem gives a detailed description of the digvijaya of Yasovarman.

17. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer by using the codes given below the lists :

List-I (Authors)	List-II (Works)
A. Bharavi	1. Karpurmanjari
B. Harsha	2. Kiratarjuniyam
C. Kalidasa	3. Malavikagnimitram
D. Rajasekhara	4. Nagananda

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) | 3 | 4 | 2 | 1 |
| (c) | 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (d) | 2 | 4 | 3 | 1 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (d)

The correctly matched pairs are :

Bharavi	-	Kiratarjuniyam
Harsha	-	Nagananda
Kalidasa	-	Malavikagnimitram
Rajasekhara	-	Karpurmanjari

18. Who wrote the book, Kiratarjuniya?

- (a) Bhatti (b) Shudraka
(c) Kalidasa (d) Bharavi
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

Kiratarjuniyam is an epic poem by Bharavi, considered the most powerful poem in Sanskrit. It consists of cantos describing the combat between Arjuna and Lord Shiva (in the guise of a kirata, or "mountain-dwelling hunter") at Indrakeeladri Hills.

19. Which of the following Sanskrit works has taken up their theme from the Mahabharata?

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (i) Naishdhiyacharita (ii) Kiratarjuniyam
(iii) Sisupalavadha (iv) Dasakumaracharita

Code :

- (a) (ii) and (iii) (b) (ii), (iii) and (iv)
(c) (i) and (iii) (d) (i), (ii) and (iii)

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

Naishadhiyacharita is a story of Nala and Damayanti in the Mahabharata written by Sriharsha; Kiratarjuniyam is an epic poem describing combat between Arjuna and Lord Shiva in the Mahabharata. Magha wrote Sisupalavadha, which is based on the Mahabharata in which Sisupala insulted Lord Krishna, who beheaded him in the ensuing duel, and Dashkumarcharitam was written by Dandi and is related to adventures of 10 princes. Thus options (1), (2) and (3) are related to the theme of Mahabharata.

20. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer

List-I	List-II
A. Vishakhadatta	1. Medicine
B. Varahamihira	2. Drama
C. Charaka	3. Astronomy
D. Brahmagupta	4. Mathematics

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	3	4	2
(b)	2	1	3	4
(c)	2	3	1	4
(d)	3	4	1	2

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

The Mudrarakshasa is a historical drama in Sanskrit by Vishakhadatta. Varahamihira was a renowned Indian astronomer. Brihat Jataka, Brihat Samhita and Panch Siddhantika are some of his leading literary works. Charaka was the famous court physician of Kanishka. He is known for his composition Charaka Samhita. Brahmagupta was an Indian mathematician.

21. Match List-I with List-II :

List-I	List-II
A. Charaka	1. Mathematics
B. Brahmagupta	2. Medicine
C. Varahamihira	3. Playwright
D. Vishakhadatta	4. Astrology

Select the correct answer using the codes given below

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	1	4	3
(b)	1	2	3	4
(c)	3	2	4	1
(d)	1	4	3	2

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Charaka was a physician who is believed to have lived during the 1st-2nd century CE, although exact date of birth and death is uncertain. Brahmagupta belonged to Gupta dynasty and was a renowned astronomer and mathematician. Varahamihira was an astrologer and Vishakhadatta was a playwright during Gupta dynasty.

22. Charaka Samhita is related to which of the following subjects?

- (a) Arthashastra (b) Politics
(c) Medicine (d) Religion

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (c)

Charaka-Samhita is a comprehensive text on ancient Indian medicine known as Ayurveda. It was written by Acharya Charaka who is known as the father of Indian medicine.

23. Charak Samhita is divided into how many chapters and sections?

- (a) 60 chapters and 8 sections
(b) 120 chapters and 8 sections
(c) 100 chapters and 5 sections
(d) 80 chapters and 7 sections

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Charaka is the renowned author of the oldest surviving text in Ayurveda, the Charaka Samhita. Its contents are divided into 120 chapters in eight sections.

24. Which of the following is not written by Varahamihira?

- (a) Panchasiddhantika (b) Brihat Samhita
(c) Brihat Jataka (d) Amarkosha

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

Amarkosha was written by Amarsimha. Varahamihira has written Panchasiddhantika, Brihat Samhita and Brihat Jataka.

25. The Panchasiddhantika of Varahamihira is based upon –

- (a) Persian astronomy
(b) Greek astronomy
(c) Iranian astronomy
(d) Mesopotamian astronomy

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (b)

The Panchasiddhantika of Varahamihira is based on Greek astronomy.

26. Nitisara, an early book of politics, was written by

- (a) Kautilya (b) Kamandaka
(c) Charaka (d) None of them

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Nitisara was written by Kamandaka. It refined the field of political thought in India and became one of the most influential works in the genre across South and Southeast Asia.

27. Which one of the following is not correctly matched?

- | | | |
|--------------|---|---------------------|
| (a) Kalidasa | - | Raghuvansa |
| (b) Bhasa | - | Svapna Vasavadattam |
| (c) Subandhu | - | Kadambari |
| (d) Harsha | - | Ratnavali |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (c)

Option (c) is not correctly matched because Kadambari was composed by Banabhatta, not by Subandhu. The rest of the options are correctly matched.

28. 'Milindapanha' is a –

- | | |
|--------------------|--------------------|
| (a) Sanskrit drama | (b) Jain chronicle |
| (c) Pali text | (d) Persian epic |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

The Milindapanha is a Buddhist book in the Pali language which purports to be a dialogue between the Indian monk Nagasena and the Indo-Greek king Milinda (Menander).

29. Buddhist text 'Milindapanha' throws light on which Indo-Greek ruler?

- | | |
|------------------|---------------|
| (a) Diodorus -II | (b) Demetrius |
| (c) Menander | (d) Strato- I |

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

30. Milindapanha is in the form of a dialogue between king Menander and Buddhist monk :

- | | |
|---------------|--------------------|
| (a) Nagarjuna | (b) Nagabhatta |
| (c) Nagasena | (d) Kumarilabhatta |

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

31. 'Milindpanha' is in the form of a dialogue between King Milind and Buddhist Saint. The concerned saint was –

- | | |
|-------------------|--------------|
| (a) Nagarjun | (b) Nagasena |
| (c) Kumaril Bhatt | (d) Nagbhatt |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

32. Milindapanha is based on the questions of King Milinda. In which language was it written?

- | | |
|--------------|------------|
| (a) Sanskrit | (b) Hindi |
| (c) Pali | (d) Arabic |

Uttarakhand PCS (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

33. The religious text which explains about the eight different phases of agricultural works :

- | | |
|--------------------|----------------------------|
| (a) Avadanashataka | (b) Aryamanjushrimulakalpa |
| (c) Milindapanha | (d) Deepavansa |

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

Milindapanha written by Buddhist monk Nagasena is religious text that explains about the eight different phases of agricultural works. Book is written in the Pali language and comprises of a conversation between Nagasena and Indo-Greek ruler Menander.

34. Which of the following pairs is incorrectly matched?

- | |
|------------------------------------|
| (a) Prithviraj Raso – Chand Bardai |
| (b) Bisaldeva Raso – Narapati |
| (c) Khuman Raso – Karnidan |
| (d) Shatrusal Raso – Dungar Singh |
| (e) Question not attempted |

Rajasthan P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

The correct pairings are as follows:

- Prithviraj Raso – Chand Bardai
- Bisaldeva Raso – Narapati
- Khuman Raso – Dalpati Vijay
- Shatrusal Raso – Dungar Singh

Thus, among the given options, option (c) is incorrectly matched.

35. With reference to Indian history, consider the following texts.

1. Nettipakarana
2. Parishishtaparvan
3. Avadanashataka
4. Trishashtilakshana Mahapurana

Which of the above are Jaina texts?

- | | |
|----------------|------------------|
| (a) 1, 2 and 3 | (b) 2 and 4 only |
| (c) 1, 3 and 4 | (d) 2, 3 and 4 |

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Parishishtaparvan (by Hemchandra) and Trishashtilakshana Mahapurana (by Chavund Rai or Chamund Rai) are Jain texts while Nettipakarana and Avadanashataka are Buddhist texts.

36. Match List- I with List- II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists :

- | | |
|-----------------|---------------------|
| List- I | List- II |
| (Court Poet) | (King) |
| A. Amir Khusrau | 1. Chandra Gupta II |
| B. Kalidasa | 2. Samudra Gupta |
| C. Harisena | 3. Harshavardhana |
| D. Banabhatta | 4. Allauddin Khalji |

Code :

A	B	C	D
(a) 1	2	3	4
(b) 4	1	2	3
(c) 4	3	2	1
(d) 2	4	1	3

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (b)

The correctly matched pairs are :
 King - Court Poet
 Chandra Gupta II - Kalidasa (Kumarasambhavam, Raghuvansham, Malavikagnimitram)
 Samudra Gupta - Harisena
 Harshavardhana - Banabhatta
 Allauddin Khajji - Amir Khusrau

37. The contemporary ruler of Kalhana, the author of Rajatarangini was –

- (a) Jai Singh (b) Harsha
 (c) Govindchandra (d) Jayachandra

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (a)

Jai Singh (1128-1149) was the contemporary ruler of Kalhana from Kashmir. Kalhana was the author of Rajatarangini, and he completed this pioneer creation during the reign of Jai Singh. Rajatarangini is a collection of 8 Taranga and 7826 verses. The conventional ancient history of Kashmir is narrated in the first three Tarangas.

38. How many Tarangas are in Rajatarangini of Kalhana?

- (a) Eight (b) Nine
 (c) Ten (d) Eleven

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

39. Who among the following continued the Rajatarangini of Kalhana:

- (a) Bilhana and Merutunga
 (b) Bilhana and Mammata
 (c) Jonaraja and Merutunga
 (d) Jonaraja and Srivara

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

Rajatarangini, a metrical historical chronicle of the north-western Indian subcontinent, particularly the kings of Kashmir, was written in Sanskrit by Kashmiri Brahmin Kalhana in the 12th century. Jonaraja continued the narration down to the reign of Sultan Zainul Abedin and called it, like Kalhana, Rajatarangini (Rajavali). After the death of Jonaraja, his pupil Srivara continued the history of Kashmir.

40. Saundarananda was the composition of:

- (a) Ashvaghosha (b) Banabhatta
 (c) Bhavbhuti (d) Bhaas

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (a)

Ashvaghosha, a noted poet, is considered to be instrumental in the propagation of Buddhism. He was also the writer of a famous court poem of his time called the Saundarananda Kavya.

41. "Nagananda", 'Ratnavali' and 'Priyadarshika' were written by:

- (a) Bana Bhatta (b) Vishakha Datta
 (c) Vatsyayan (d) Harshavardhana

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

Besides being a great conqueror, a religious-minded and generous king, Harshavardhana was also a great patron of education and learning. He is supposed to be the author of 'Ratnavali,' 'Priyadarshika' and 'Nagananda'.

42. Which of the following works were authored by Harsha?

1. Priyadarshika 2. Nagananda
 3. Harshacharita 4. Ratnavali

Select your answer using the codes given below:

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (b) 1, 2 and 4
 (c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 2 and 3

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

43. Which among the following plays was written by Harshavardhan?

- (a) Harshacharita (b) Kadambari
 (c) Devichandraguptam (d) Priyadarshika

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

Priyadarshika is written by Harshavardhan.

44. Among the four works mentioned below which one is encyclopedic in nature?

- (a) Amarakosha (b) Siddhantasiromani
 (c) Brihat Samhita (d) Ashtangahridayam

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (c)

Brihat Samhita of Varaha Mihira is an encyclopedic work written during the Gupta period.

45. With reference to the history of ancient India, Bhavabhuti, Hastimalla and Kshemeshvara were famous

- (a) Jain monks (b) Playwrights
(c) Temple architects (d) Philosophers

I.A.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans. (b)

Bhavabhuti, a major dramatist of the later Sanskrit dramatic period, was the court poet of King Yashovarman of Kannauj, in north India 8th CE. The works attributed to poet Bhavabhuti were Mahaviracharitam (depicting the early life of Rama). Malatimadhava, a play based on the romance of Malati and Madhava and Uttararamacharitam. Hastimalla is a Kannada poet and playwright during the reign of Hoysalas. Kshemeshvara (990-c. 1070 CE) was an 11th-century Sanskrit poet from Kashmir in India. One of the important works attributed to him is Dasavatar Charita.

46. Which of the following pairs are correctly matched?

1. Mrichchhakatikam - Sudraka
2. Buddhacharita - Vasuvandhu
3. Mudrarakshasa - Vishakhadatta
4. Harshacharita - Banabhatta

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (b) 1, 3 and 4
(c) 1 and 4 (d) 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

Buddhacharita was not composed by Vasubandhu. In fact it is a poetic narrative of the life of Buddha by the Sanskrit poet Ashvaghosha. Remaining pairs are correctly matched. Thus, option (b) is the correct answer.

47. With reference to the scholars/litterateurs of ancient India, consider the following statements:

- (1) Panini is associated with Pushyamitra Shunga.
 - (2) Amarasingha is Gupta associated with Harshavardhana
 - (3) Kalidasa is associated with Chandra Gupta-II
- Which of the above statements are right
- (a) Only 1 and 2 (b) Only 2 and 3
(c) Only 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

[I.A.S. (Pre)-2020]

Ans. (c)

Chandragupta-II was known for his deep interest in art and culture and nine gems or Navratna adorned his court. Great poet Kalidasa was most prominent Ratna. Amarsingha was a lexicographer and was also among the Navratna. Patanjali was associated with Pushyamitra Shunga while Panini belonged to probably The 7th century B.C. He wrote Astadhyayi.

48. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists :

- | List I (Author) | List II (Text) |
|------------------|-------------------------|
| A. Varahamihira | 1. Prabandha Chintamani |
| B. Vishakhadatta | 2. Mrichchha-Katikam |
| C. Sudraka | 3. Brihat-Samhita |

D. Bilhana

4. Devi-Chandraguptam

5. Vikramankadevacharita

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 3 | 4 | 5 | 2 |
| (b) | 3 | 4 | 2 | 5 |
| (c) | 5 | 3 | 4 | 1 |
| (d) | 1 | 3 | 5 | 2 |

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

The correctly matched pairs are :

Varahamihira - Brihat Samhita
Vishakhadatta - Devi-Chandraguptam
Sudraka - Mrichchha-Katikam
Bilhana - Vikramankadev Charita
Prabandha Chintamani was composed by Merutungacharya.

49. With reference to ancient Indian history, consider the following pairs :

- | Literary work | Author |
|----------------------|------------------|
| 1. Devichandragupta | Bihana |
| 2. Hammira Mahakavya | Nayachandra Suri |
| 3. Milinda-panha | Nagarjuna |
| 4. Nitivakyamrita | Somadeva Suri |

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one (b) Only two
(c) Only three (d) All four

I.A.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

- | Literary work | Author |
|-------------------|------------------|
| Devichandragupta | Vishakadutta |
| Hammira-Mahakavya | Nayachandra Suri |
| Milinda-Panha | Nagasen |
| Nitivakyamrita | Somadeva Suri |

50. Which among the following sources throw light on the history of Parmar Dynasty?

- (a) Navsahsank Charit of Padmagupta
(b) Prabandha Chintamani of Merutunga
(c) Udaipur Prashasti
(d) All of the above

[M.P.P.C.S. (Pre)-2019]

Ans. (d)

The sources that shed light on the history of Parmar dynasty are Navsahsank Charit of Padmagupta, Prabandha Chintamani of Merutunga, Harsola copper plate inscription of Siyaka-II, Bhoj's record of Banswara and Betma, Udaipur Prashasti of Udayaditya period etc. In Navsahsank Charita, Mount Abu is described as origin place of Parmaras.

51. Which of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

- | | |
|-----------------------|-----------------|
| (a) Karpurmanjari | - Harsha |
| (b) Malavikagnimitram | - Kalidasa |
| (c) Mudrarakshasa | - Vishakhadatta |
| (d) Saundarananda | - Asvaghosha |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (a)

Karpuramanjari was not written by Harsha. It was written by Rajshekhar, poet laureate of Gurjar-Pratihara.

52. Who wrote 'Shakuntalam'?

- | | |
|----------------|----------------|
| (a) Bana Bhatt | (b) Ved Vyasa |
| (c) Kalidasa | (d) Bhavabhuti |

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

Kalidasa was a Sanskrit poet and dramatist and probably the greatest Indian writer of any epoch. The seven works identified as genuine are (1) Abhigyanashakuntalam, (2) Vikramorvashiyam, (3) Malavikagnimitram, (4) Raghuvamsham, (5) Kumarasambhavam, (6) Meghadutam, (7) Ritusamharam.

53. Which of the following is not a literary masterpiece of Kalidasa?

- | | |
|----------------------|----------------------|
| (a) Mrichchhakatikam | (b) Meghduta |
| (c) Ritu Sangham | (d) Vikramorvashiyam |

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Mrichchhakatikam was not a literary work by Kalidasa. It was composed by Sudraka.

54. The protagonist of the play 'Malvikagnimitram', written by Kalidasa, is –

- | | |
|------------------------|----------------------------|
| (a) Pushyamitra Shunga | (b) Gautamiputra Satakarni |
| (c) Agnimitra | (d) Chandragupta- II |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)

The first play composed by the great poet Kalidasa is Malavikagnimitram. Often it is called Kalidasa Malavikagnimitram, as an honour to Kalidasa. This play consists of 5 acts about the love story of King Agnimitra of Vidisha from the Shunga dynasty.

55. Which one of the following books of ancient India has the love story of the son of the founder of Sunga dynasty?

- | | |
|-----------------------|----------------------|
| (a) Swapnavasavadatta | (b) Malavikagnimitra |
| (c) Meghadoota | (d) Ratnavali |

I.A.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

56. The author of 'Swapnavasavadatta' is

- | | |
|----------------|----------------|
| (a) Kalidasa | (b) Bhasa |
| (c) Bhavabhuti | (d) Rajshekhar |

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

'Svapnavasavadattam' is a Sanskrit play written by the great poet Bhasa.

57. Which one of the following is a work attributed to playwright Bhasa?

- | | |
|----------------------|------------------|
| (a) Kavyalankara | (b) Natyashastra |
| (c) Madhyama-vyayoga | (d) Mahabhashya |

I.A.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

The Sanskrit play Madhyama-vyayoga is attributed to Bhasa. Kavyalankara was written by Bhamaha. Natyashastra is a detailed treatise and handbook on dramatic art that deals with all aspects of classical Sanskrit theatre. It is traditionally attributed to Bharata Muni. Mahabhashya was written by Patanjali.

58. Who is the author of 'Geet Govind'?

- | | |
|--------------|-------------|
| (a) Jayadeva | (b) Surdasa |
| (c) Kesava | (d) Mira |

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (a)

Geet Govind is an epic poem written in Sanskrit by Jayadev in the twelfth century. Jayadev was the royal poet in the court of King Lakshman Sen of Bengal. It is organized into twelve chapters.

59. Whose court was embellished by 'Jaydev,' composer of Geet Govind?

- | | |
|----------------|-------------------|
| (a) Dharmapala | (b) Devpala |
| (c) Vijayasen | (d) Lakshmana Sen |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

60. Who had composed the 'Gita Govinda'?

- | | |
|--------------|----------------------|
| (a) Dhoyin | (b) Govardhanacharya |
| (c) Jayadeva | (d) Lakshmana Sena |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

61. Match the List- I with List - II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List – I (Compositions) List – II (Subject)

- | | |
|------------------------|------------|
| A. Ashtanga - Samgraha | 1. Play |
| B. Das rupaka | 2. Grammar |
| C. Lilavati | 3. Maths |

D. Mahabhasya**4. Medical****Code :**

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	2	1	4
(b)	4	1	3	2
(c)	2	3	4	1
(d)	1	4	2	3

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002**Ans. (b)**

The correctly matched pairs are :

Ashtanga Samgraha - Medical

Das rupaka - Play

Lilavati - Maths

Mahabhasya - Grammar

62. Thy right is to work only, but never with its fruits. This is stated in which of the following books?

- (a) Astadhyayi (b) Mahabhasya
(c) Geeta (d) Mahabharata

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992**Ans. (c)**

“Thy right is to work only, but never with its fruits”
(कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु... कदाचन्.....). These lines are
stated in Shrimad Bhagavad Geeta.

63. Name the source that is silent about the trade routes of ancient India

- (a) Sangam Sahitya (b) Milindpanha
(c) Jataka Tales (d) All of the above

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994**Ans. (a)**

Sangama Sahitya is silent about the trade routes of ancient India.

64. In which epic it was told, “what is here is also found elsewhere, but if not here is found nowhere else –

- (a) Ramayana (b) Mahabharata
(c) Geeta (d) Rajtarangini

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992**Ans. (b)**

The above statement is mentioned in the epic Mahabharata.

65. Which ancient Indian book has been translated into 15 (fifteen) Indian and 40 (forty) foreign languages?

- (a) Hitopadesha (b) Panchatantra
(c) Katha Saritsagar (d) Shakuntala

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010**R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1992****Ans. (b)**

Panchatantra is a collection of Indian animal fables that has extensive circulation both in the country of its origin and worldwide. It has been translated into 15 Indian and 40 foreign languages. It was compiled in Sanskrit (Hindu) and Pali (Buddhist). The compilation attributed to Pandit Vishnu Sharma. In the Mughal era, it was translated by Abul Fazl under the name of Ayar-e-danish.

66. ‘Panchatantra’ was originally written by –

- (a) Kalidasa (b) Vishnu Sharma
(c) Tulsidas (d) Raidas

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of above question.

67. Match the List- I with List- II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:**List-I****A. Sarvavarma****B. Sudraka****C. Vigyaneshwara****D. Kalhana****List-II****1. Mitakshara****2. Rajtarangini****3. Mrichhakatikam****4. Katantra****Code :**

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	4	2	1
(b)	4	3	1	2
(c)	2	1	4	3
(d)	4	2	1	3

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2002**U.P. P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2003****Ans. (b)**

The correctly matched order is :

Sarvavarma	-	Katantra
Sudraka	-	Mrichhakatikam
Vigyaneshwara	-	Mitakshara
Kalhana	-	Rajtarangini

68. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below :**List-I (Authors)****A. Devana Bhatta****B. Hemadri****C. Madhvacharya****D. Ballal Sena****List-II (Works)****1. Daan Sagar****2. Parashar Madhav****3. Chaturvarga****Chintamani****4. Smriti Chandrika****Code :**

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	4	1	3
(b)	1	4	2	3
(c)	3	2	1	4
(d)	4	3	2	1

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

The correct matching of List-I and List-II is as follows:

List-I (Authors)	List-II (Works)
Devana Bhatta	Smriti Chandrika
Hemadri	Chaturvarga
	Chintamani
Madhvacharya	Parashar Madhav
Ballal Sena	Daan Sagar

69. With reference to the history of ancient India, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Mitakshara was the civil law for upper castes and Dayabhaga was the civil law for lower castes.
2. In the Mitakshara system, the sons can claim right to the property during the lifetime of the father, whereas in the Dayabhaga system, it is only after the death of the father that the sons can claim right to the property.
3. The Mitakshara system deals with the matters related to the property held by male members only of a family, whereas the Dayabhaga system deals with the matters related to the property held by both male and female members of a family.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 3 only

I.A.S. (Pre)-2021

Ans. (b)

Mitakshara is a vivarti on the Yajnavalkya smriti, written by Vijnanesvara. Dayabhaga is a Hindu law treatise written by Jimutavahana. These treatises deal with the laws of inheritance. Hence statement (1) is wrong. In Mitakshara system, the sons can claim right to the property during the lifetime of the father, whereas in Dayabhaga system, it is only after the death of the father that the sons can claim right to the property. Hence statement (2) is right. Mitakshara system deals with matters related to the property held by both male and female members of a family. While Dayabhaga only deals with matters related to the property held by male members of a family. So, statement (3) is also wrong.

70. Who of the following is especially known for his contribution in the field of Algebra?

- (a) Aryabhatta (b) Brahmagupta
(c) Bhaskar (d) Lall

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

Bhaskaracharya is also known as Bhaskara - II represents a significant contribution to mathematical and astronomical knowledge in the 12th century. There are six well-known works of Bhaskaracharya his book 'Siddhantasiromani', has four parts Lilavati, Bijaganita (Algebra), Ganitadhyaya and Goladhyay.

71. The author of 'Lilavati', Bhaskar-II was :

- (a) Physician (b) Mathematician

(c) Musician

(d) Sculptor

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

72. 'Lilavati' a treatise on Mathematics, was written by –

- (a) Ramanuj (b) Kautilya
(c) Amartya Sen (d) Bhaskaracharya

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

73. Aryabhatta was –

- (a) Indian Politician
(b) Indian Mathematician and Astronomer
(c) Indian Sanskrit Scholar and Poet
(d) None of these

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (b)

Aryabhatta was a renowned mathematician and astronomer of ancient India. One of his major works was Aryabhatiya. The book deals with many topics like astronomy, spherical trigonometry, arithmetic, algebra and plane trigonometry. In the field of astronomy, Aryabhatta was the pioneer to infer that the earth is spherical and rotates on its axis around the sun. He is also considered to be the father of Trigonometry.

74. Which one of the following Indian Mathematicians invented decimal place value ?

- (a) Bhaskar (b) Varahmihira
(c) Brahmagupta (d) Aryabhatta

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (d)

Aryabhatta, an Indian mathematician, discovered the decimal place.

75. Who was the author of "Matta Vilasa Prahasana"?

- (a) Gautamiputra Satakarni
(b) Mahakshatrap Rudradaman
(c) Mahendra Varman
(d) Pulakesin II

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

Mattavilasa Prahasana was written by the versatile Pallava ruler and scholar Mahendra Varman-I, which describes the social and religious life.

76. The author of 'Lalit Vigharaj' drama was –

- (a) Hemchandra (b) Kalhan
(c) Somdeva (d) Mahesh
(e) Question not attempted

Raj. P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

'Lalit Vigharaj' was authored by Somadeva.